

# The 6:15

FRIDAY · SEPTEMBER 11, 2026

NO. 13

## THE BOARD

### CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS)

|                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Fri 9/11 (today)</b> | Aug. CPI, 8:30a (BLS) — cons. headline +0.4% m/m/~3.3-3.4% y/y (sources split on the y/y); core +0.2% m/m/2.4% y/y. Last print before FOMC.                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Tue 9/15</b>         | Delaware statewide primary — last 2026 primary on the calendar. Sen: Coons (D-inc.) vs. Beardsley (D primary), Katz vs. Shulli (R primary); At-large House: McBride (D-inc.); AG: Jennings (D-inc.) vs. Bensing vs. Rickman; Treasurer: Lauzen vs. Smith (D). Field fixed through Nov. 3 after this. |
| <b>[scheduled]</b>      | SpaceX Starship Flight 14 — one tracker lists NET 9/15, another (CADENA COMPASS) NET 9/18 <b>[dates diverge, not reconciled]</b> . ~20 Starlink V3 sats, first operational-deployment Starship flight.                                                                                               |
| <b>Tue-Wed 9/15-16</b>  | FOMC — decision/SEP Wed 2p, presser 2:30p. Hike odds jumped to ~69-70% (CME FedWatch, Fri a.m.) from 56-60% Wed — the sharpest single-day repricing of this cycle.                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>[NEW]</b>            | Apple confirmed its foldable — "iPhone Duo" — at Tuesday's event: ~7.8in inner display, A20 Pro chip, dual 48MP cameras, from \$1,999; preorder 5a PT 10/16, ships 10/23.                                                                                                                            |
| <b>[DEVELOPING]</b>     | Anthropic IPO — no public S-1 located this run; late-Sept./early-Oct. Nasdaq target unchanged.                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

Correction: last issue listed weekly jobless claims as due alongside today's CPI; claims are a Thursday release and already printed 9/10 (see Economics).

### METRICS · AS OF ~6:15A ET FRI 9/11 UNLESS NOTED

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Oil</b> | Brent settled \$107.63 Thu (+5.9%) — highest close since 5/19 (\$111.28); WTI settled \$102.48 Thu (+6.7%), also since-5/19 high; spread ~\$5.15. Fri a.m. indicative (pre-settle): Brent \$106.11 (-1.41%), WTI \$102.59 (+0.11%). |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Rates</b>                     | 10Y ~4.95-4.96% Fri a.m. — cusp of 5%, highest since Nov. 2023; 2Y 4.39% (Wed 9/9) <b>[stale]</b> ; 30Y 5.25% (Wed 9/9) <b>[stale]</b> . Treasury ran a \$6B long-dated buyback this week; 10Y kept climbing after it regardless. |
| <b>FX/Vol</b>                    | DXY ~99.05-99.11 range Fri a.m.; VIX 17.84 (+8.38%, +1.38pts) — week's sharpest vol jump.                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Futures</b>                   | ~6:15a Fri, pre-CPI: Dow +130 to +151pts (+0.2-0.3%); S&P +0.17-0.19%; Nasdaq roughly flat — a bounce after Thu's 4th straight losing session (Dow -2.5% on the week entering Fri).                                               |
| <b>Equities (Thu 9/10 close)</b> | Dow 52,381.08 (-0.77%); S&P 500 7,638.95 (-0.45%); Nasdaq Comp. 26,253.34 (-0.64%).                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Asia/Europe</b>               | Nikkei 64,011.34 (-1.93%, Fri close); Kospi -1.76% (Fri); Hang Seng -0.6% (Fri, late trade); FTSE 100 14,357 (-0.7%, Thu close) — no fresher Stoxx 600/DAX/CAC/FTSE MIB close than Mon 9/7 located <b>[stale]</b> .               |
| <b>Gold/Gas</b>                  | Gold ~\$4,348/oz Fri a.m. (+0.71% on the day, still down from \$4,477 on 9/5); retail gas \$4.27/gal natl. avg (AAA, 9/11), +13¢ in a week.                                                                                       |

Crude: ICE Brent/NYMEX WTI front-month. Rates: Fed H.15/CME. Equities: exchange closes via CNBC/Reuters.

## HORMUZ COUNTERS

|                        |                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Closure</b>         | Day 194 (straits.live, own start date, 9/11 1021Z) vs. Day 195 (globalsecurity.org, wider-war count, 9/10) — different baselines, not reconciled.                             |
| <b>Transits</b>        | Kpler 10-day avg. 13/day; Lloyd's List ~12/day (8/26-9/1) <b>[flagged possibly incomplete]</b> ; straits.live single-day count 6 on 9/6 vs. ~85/day baseline (~7% of normal). |
| <b>Dark tankers</b>    | straits.live: 0 went dark past 24h vs. 7-day avg. 56.3; Al Jazeera (late Aug.) called "majority" of crossings dark <b>[different windows/methods, not comparable]</b> .       |
| <b>War-risk premia</b> | ~\$10.0M/VLCC passage, ~40x peacetime (straits.live, "set 24d ago") — unchanged order of magnitude.                                                                           |
| <b>Strikes (24h)</b>   | 3 lower-grade incidents (straits.live): Iran claims a US Saildrone destroyed <b>[unverified]</b> ; Houthis reach Perim                                                        |

Island; Houthis reportedly seize Mokha port — the latter two are Bab el-Mandeb, not Hormuz. No confirmed US-Iran exchange in the strict last 24h. Running total not maintained by this issue.

Kpler's AIS daily counts, Lloyd's List's weekly averages, and straits.live's day-specific snapshots and dropout tracking measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged.

## TRANSACTIONS

|                     |                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Yankees</b>      | Beat Rockies 10-3 Thu — 83-62; lead AL wild card by 3 over Boston (10 over Toronto for 3rd spot), magic number 5; trail Tampa Bay by 4 in AL East. |
| <b>Knicks</b>       | Hart extension still unsigned; no new figure since Wed's narrowed 3-yr/\$60-62M range.                                                             |
| <b>Northwestern</b> | Bye week done, 1-0; hosts Colorado Sat. 9/19, 6:30p CT (Martin Stadium) — kickoff time newly confirmed.                                            |

## LEAD

### OIL BACK IN TRIPLE DIGITS, THE 10-YEAR ON THE CUSP OF 5%

**Oil breaks back into triple digits at its highest since May, the 10-year closes in on 5% despite a Treasury intervention meant to stop it, and both land hours before the CPI print that was already this cycle's biggest**

Thursday delivered the clearest inflation scare of the war so far, and it arrived on two fronts at once. ICE Brent settled at \$107.63, up 5.9% on the day — its highest close since May 19, when the benchmark stood at \$111.28 — while NYMEX WTI settled at \$102.48, up 6.7%, also a since-May-19 high. [NEW] [fact] The move extends the escalation this issue has tracked since Tuesday-Wednesday's multi-front strikes (five Iranian tankers destroyed, Jordan's Al Azraq air base hit, Houthi strikes on Saudi refining country, a drone hit on the CPC's Black Sea terminal) working

through the market with a lag, not a new flashpoint on its own.  
[read]

The same morning, August producer prices came in exactly at the 0.4% m/m consensus headline — "in line," on the number the market watches first — but the composition underneath was the part that moved yields. [fact] Final-demand energy rose 4.2%; diesel fuel alone jumped 24.1%, more than a third of the increase in final-demand goods; core prices (ex food, energy, and trade services) ran 4.7% higher year-over-year; stage-1 intermediate demand rose 11.3% y/y. [NEW] [fact] That is a profile of cost-push pressure building in the pipeline behind an in-line headline, and bond traders read it that way: the 10-year yield pushed to roughly 4.95-4.96%, its highest level since November 2023 and within a hair of the 5% mark that has held since then. [fact]

What makes this week's yield move different from prior inflation scares is that it happened despite an active countermeasure. The Treasury ran a \$6 billion buyback of long-dated debt this week aimed explicitly at capping long yields; Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent told Steve Bannon's podcast that any suggestion the operation isn't working is "nonsense." [NEW] [fact] The 10-year kept climbing after the buyback regardless. [fact] [read] That sequencing is the more important story for a bond investor than the CPI print due at 8:30 this morning: a policy tool built to suppress term premium visibly failing to do so, in real time, suggests the market is pricing something the Fed and Treasury can't easily talk down — a mix of oil-driven cost-push inflation and fiscal-credibility concern that a benign core CPI wouldn't directly resolve, because CPI measures consumer prices, not the term-premium and supply-driven dynamics currently pushing yields. A soft print this morning

would help sentiment, but it doesn't address the mechanism actually in play this week. [read]

Equities absorbed both moves badly: Thursday was the fourth consecutive losing session for all three major averages, with the Dow down 0.77% to 52,381.08, the S&P 500 off 0.45% to 7,638.95, and the Nasdaq down 0.64% to 26,253.34 — the Dow alone is down roughly 2.5% on the week entering Friday. [fact] Futures were modestly higher pre-market Friday (Dow +130 to +151 points, S&P +0.17-0.19%, Nasdaq roughly flat) as traders positioned into the CPI release, a small bounce that reads more like positioning than conviction given the size of Thursday's move. [fact] [read]

One genuine bright spot cut against the macro overlay: Oracle's results, released after Thursday's close, beat cleanly — adjusted EPS \$1.92 versus \$1.74 consensus, revenue \$19.35B (+30% y/y) versus \$19.14B consensus, cloud infrastructure revenue up 121% y/y to \$7.4B, and a remaining-performance-obligation backlog of \$664B against a \$639.89B estimate (up from the \$638B figure carried into this print). [NEW] [fact] Oracle raised FY27 guidance to at least \$90B revenue and \$8.10 non-GAAP EPS, and shares traded as high as roughly 10% higher after hours before settling to a 5.5% premarket gain Friday. [fact] Adobe beat too — EPS \$6.13 versus \$6.09 consensus, record revenue of \$6.76B — and raised full-year guidance, yet closed down 2.37% Thursday and was off a further 2.74% premarket Friday. [NEW] [fact] The split is the tell for how selective this tape has become: a beat tied to AI-infrastructure capex (Oracle's cloud backlog) gets rewarded even inside a risk-off week; a beat without that specific story (Adobe) gets sold regardless of the numbers. [read]

## POLITICS

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Rhode Island's primary results are in: Sen. Jack Reed (D-inc.) defeated Connor Burbridge and Luis Daniel Muñoz in Wednesday's Democratic primary, resolving last issue's flag. [NEW] [fact] Delaware's Tuesday primary is the last of the 2026 cycle — see Board for the full slate — after which the general-election field is fixed through Nov. 3. [continuity] Republicans continue to hold the House 218-214 (three vacancies) and the Senate 53-45 (two independents caucusing with Democrats); no change to either chamber's composition this run. [continuity] With the primary calendar closing out, the midterm story shifts fully to the general-election map, where a margin this narrow in both chambers keeps live the policy questions this issue's readers care about — tax and tariff authority, AI-data-center siting, and any legislative response to a war that's now pushing oil past \$100 and gas past \$4.25 a gallon heading into an election year. [read]

## ECONOMICS

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Friday's CPI (8:30a) is the last data point before the Sept. 15-16 FOMC vote. Consensus: headline +0.4% m/m, with sources split on whether the year-over-year rate eases to 3.3% or holds at 3.4%; core +0.2% m/m/2.4% y/y. [fact] That core consensus is materially softer than the +0.4% m/m figure this issue carried from earlier in the week, which appears to have been superseded as forecasters converged closer to the release — worth noting given how much the FOMC odds move has already priced in. [flag: consensus revised since Wednesday's issue, not a new data point] CME FedWatch's hike probability jumped to roughly 69-70% Friday morning from 56-60% Wednesday — the sharpest single-day repricing since this cycle

began, driven by Thursday's oil and PPI moves rather than by CPI itself, which hasn't printed yet as this issue goes to press. [fact] [read] No fresher Kalshi or Polymarket read was located this run to compare against CME's number. Thursday's weekly initial jobless claims, released alongside PPI, came in at 206,000 against a 205,000 consensus — essentially in line; continuing claims fell to 1.774M versus 1.78M expected. [NEW] [fact] That's a labor market showing no fresh stress even as the oil/yields story dominates, which leaves Gov. Waller's stated framework — support a hold "if disinflation continues," as he put it after the August jobs report — resting entirely on this morning's core print, uncomplicated by any labor-side deterioration this week. [read]

## **BUSINESS**

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Oracle and Adobe results are detailed in the Lead; both beat and raised guidance, with Oracle rewarded (+5.5% premarket) and Adobe sold (-2.74% premarket) despite comparable headline beats. [continuity, see Lead] Oracle's backlog acceleration — \$664B, up from \$638B at its fiscal year-end just one quarter ago — is the more consequential number for anyone tracking AI-capex durability: it says contracted demand is still outrunning what the company can report as revenue, not slowing. [NEW] [read] The unresolved question the print doesn't answer is financing: Oracle has been running negative free cash flow this cycle to fund the buildout behind that backlog, and nothing in Thursday's release changed that math — a bigger backlog raises the capital Oracle needs to spend to convert it, at the same moment the 10-year is pushing toward 5% and making that debt more expensive to carry. [read] No new movement located this run on Nvidia's pending Hugging Face acquisition, the FTC's Amazon ad-auction suit, or the Ford/CATL

battery-supply scrutiny — all continuity from prior issues.  
[continuity]

## TECHNOLOGY

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OpenAI's Navier-Stokes claim has turned into a credit dispute serious enough to matter beyond the math. OpenAI says its models solved the Navier-Stokes existence-and-smoothness problem — one of the Clay Institute's seven Millennium Prize problems, worth \$1M — using up to 10,000 concurrent AI agents over 88 hours, work OpenAI says began Sept. 1. [NEW] [fact] NYU mathematician Tristan Buckmaster alleges OpenAI pressured him to strip his co-author's name — a researcher affiliated with Anthropic — from the announcement; OpenAI says it never accessed the pair's unpublished work before they released it themselves. [NEW] [fact — claims conflict, neither independently verified this run] The dispute matters for reasons beyond credit: it's a live test of whether researchers can safely bring frontier-lab tools to bear on unpublished work without the lab in question later claiming or contesting the result. [read] Separately, Apple's iPhone Duo pricing and ship date are now confirmed (see Board) — the first hard numbers after weeks of unverified leaks.

## GEOPOLITICS

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Ukraine struck its deepest target yet Wednesday night into Thursday, hitting the Makhachkala Commercial Seaport in Russia's Dagestan republic — nearly 3,000 kilometers from the Ukrainian border — alongside a gas-export complex reached in the same extended-range campaign. [NEW] [fact] Russia answered with 149 strike drones overnight into Thursday across twelve regions and the DPR — Sumy, Kharkiv, Zaporizhzhia, Dnipropetrovsk, Kherson, Mykolaiv, Kyiv, Khmelnytskyi, Odesa, Chernihiv, Poltava and Cherkasy — hitting a food-industry facility in Dnipro with casualties reported. [NEW] [fact] Neither side advanced on the ground Thursday, per ISW's assessment. [fact] The Wednesday Black Sea strikes on Novorossiysk and the frigate Admiral Essen carry over unchanged from the last issue and aren't repeated here. [continuity] The range on Wednesday's Dagestan strike — nearly 3,000km, deep into Russia's Caspian-facing energy infrastructure — matters for the same reason this issue's Lead flagged Wednesday's Black Sea and Saudi strikes: it's another piece of non-Gulf energy infrastructure now inside the war's reach, widening the set of assets a ceasefire would eventually need to cover. [read] No breakthrough or scheduled follow-up round from the Witkoff-Kushner shuttle was located this run. [continuity]

## IRAN & HORMUZ

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The most consequential Hormuz-adjacent development this run isn't a strike but a treaty clause getting tested. Pakistan's defense minister said Sept. 9 that an Iranian attack on Saudi Arabia could activate the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement — the mutual-defense pact

Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Turkey signed Aug. 7, explicitly compared by Turkey's foreign minister to NATO's Article 5, though officials maintain it isn't directed at Iran. [NEW] [fact] That statement, on its own, doesn't change anything operationally, but it puts a three-country mutual-defense mechanism explicitly into play for the first time since the pact was signed — a genuine escalation-risk widening if Saudi Arabia is struck again after last week's Jazan-area attacks. [read] Separately, a damage assessment of the Jordan missile barrage — an A-10 with wing damage, roughly eight F-15E jets lightly damaged but serviceable — is circulating in regional and aggregator reporting; it has not been confirmed by CENTCOM or Jordan's military and should be treated cautiously. [flag: single-sourced, not officially confirmed] The Bab el-Mandeb developments noted in the Board (Perim Island, Mokha port) sit in the Red Sea theater, not the Strait of Hormuz proper — worth tracking as a possible second chokepoint but distinct from this issue's Hormuz counters. [read]

## SPORTS

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|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Yankees</b> | Beat Rockies 10-3 Thu. 83-62; lead AL wild card by 3 over Boston, magic number 5; trail Tampa Bay by 4 in the AL East. |
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|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Knicks</b> | Hart extension still unsigned; no new figure since Wednesday. |
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|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Northwestern</b> | Bye week done, 1-0; hosts Colorado Sat. 9/19, 6:30p CT. |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|

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**Continuity.** Dropped as resolved since Wednesday: Rhode Island's primary (results in — Reed won); Apple's foldable pricing/date (confirmed). Dropped as unchanged and not repeated: Nvidia-Hugging Face regulatory review; Amazon FTC suit; Ford/CATL scrutiny; GPT-6 Astra Plus/Free rollout; Anthropic IPO timeline. Watch: this morning's CPI and its FOMC read-through, given hike odds already at ~70% on oil/PPI alone before CPI printed; whether the Treasury's buyback shows any effect on the 10-year over coming sessions; Delaware's primary Tuesday; Starship Flight 14's actual date (9/15 vs. 9/18 diverge); full-session Oracle/Adobe reaction; the OpenAI-Anthropic Navier-Stokes credit dispute; any follow-up on Pakistan's Mecca-pact comment; the Bab el-

Mandeb situation at Mokha and Perim Island.

**Unverified figures** are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.